

Willard Robinson

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Education

North Carolina State University , Ph.D. Economics	2027 (expected)
Committee: Spencer Banzhaf (advisor), Erin Sills , Roger von Haefen , Zhenxuan Wang	
Montana State University , M.S. Applied Economics	2022
Appalachian State University , B.A. Economics (<i>summa cum laude</i>)	2020
Minor: Mathematics	

Research fields

Fields: Environmental and natural resource economics, environmental markets, nonmarket valuation

Working papers

- Asymmetric Information and Costly Participation in Voluntary Conservation Markets* (**Job market paper**) [\[PDF\]](#)
- Adoption Costs for Offsets: Evidence from California* [\[PDF\]](#)
- Under review
 - First place, *William D. Toussaint Best Paper Award*, NC State Economics Department

Works in progress

- Recreation Welfare Effects with Climate Change-Induced Migration*
- Impacts of Centralized Budget Policy on National Parks: An analysis of the Federal Land Recreation Enhancement Act*
- The Value of Shoreline Recreational Fishing Across Time and Space: An internal meta-regression approach* (with [Sasha Naumenko](#), [Colton Leach](#), and [Roger von Haefen](#))
- Stability in Centralized College Major Assignment* (with [Umut Dur](#))

Research experience

CEnREP graduate research assistant for Prof. Spencer Banzhaf	Jan. 2024–present
• “Making Markets Work” • “The Market for Environmental Offsets”	
Graduate research assistant for Prof. Umut Dur	Jan. 2025–Jan. 2026
• “Stability in Centralized College Major Assignment”	
Graduate research assistant for Prof. Nick Hagerty	Aug. 2020–May 2022
• “Anticipatory Effects of Regulating the Commons” with Ellen Bruno (2025), <i>Journal of Environmental Economics and Management</i>, vol. 132: 103183	
Research assistant for Prof. John Whitehead	Jun. 2019–May 2020
• Nonmarket valuation	
Research assistant for Prof. Brock Stoddard	Jun. 2019–May 2020
• Experimental economics	

Seminars and conference presentations (including scheduled*)

Asymmetric Information and Transaction Costs in Voluntary Conservation Markets (all in 2026)

Camp Resources XXXII, North Carolina State University, Triangle Theory Workshop*, AERE @ the Southern Economic Association*, Appalachian State University*, East Carolina University*

Adoption Costs for Offsets: Evidence from California

NCSU Economics Third Year Workshop (2026)

Impacts of Centralized Budget Policy on National Parks: An analysis of the Federal Land Recreation Enhancement Act

Property and Environment Research Center (2025), Appalachian Experimental and Environmental Workshop (2024)

Recreation Welfare Effects with Climate Change-Induced Migration

NCSU Graduate Student Seminar Series (2025)

Awards and fellowships

Andrew J. & Thelma K. Bartley Endowed Graduate Fellowship, NC State Poole College of Management	2026
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NBER travel grant	2026
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First place, Best Paper Award, NC State Department of Economics	2026
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PERC graduate summer fellowship, Property and Environment Research Center	2025
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Top student in economics, Appalachian State University	2020
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Professional activities

Referee service

AERE @ the Southern Economic Association conference, Environmental Research Letters

University service

Graduate student seminar organizer, NCSU	2025–present
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Vice President, Economics Graduate Student Association, NCSU	2024–present
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Membership

American Economic Association

Association of Environmental and Resource Economists

European Association of Environmental Resource Economists

References

Spencer Banzhaf

Professor

North Carolina State University

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Roger von Haefen

Professor

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Zhenxuan Wang

Assistant Professor

North Carolina State University

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